

Research Article

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Impact of Perceived Service Quality on Repurchase Intention and Word of Mouth: Mediating Role of Customer Satisfaction

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Abstract: The current study provides and tests an integrated model that examines customer satisfaction as a mediator among the relationship of perceived service quality, repurchase intention, and word of mouth. This research was a quantitative study. A convenience sampling technique was used for this research. Data was collected from those people who are availing hotel services in different cities of Pakistan. The sample size of this study was 210. SPSS software was used for data analysis. Findings of this research show that if the service provider of the hotel industry provides quality services to the customers, then customers will be happy and satisfied. If the customer is satisfied with the service provider, he will reuse those particular services in the future if needed and also generate positive word of mouth and voluntarily promote that particular service provider to others as well. Managers should try to establish those kind of strategies which helps to provide a quality and satisfying consumption experience to their customers, which can lead towards repurchase intention and positive word of mouth.

Key Words: Perceived Service Quality (PSQ), Customer Satisfaction (CS), Repurchase Intentions (RPI), Word of Mouth (WOM)

Introduction

Service quality is known as an important indicator for customer satisfaction. Previous studies suggest that customer in this modern era wants to spend less time and effort on selecting a service provider for reuse purposes (Yang et al., 2024). Customer wants to purchase the product or services with a minimum time because the value of time is vital to customers. The customer considers high value of time and accepts it as good for the customer (Singh et al., 2025). In the hotel industry, the quality of services remains vital for customer satisfaction because customer judges service providers based on the quality of services they provide to customers (Kalnaovakul et al., 2025). Service quality is also the key indicator for consumer post-purchase behaviour. If the quality of the service is good, then the customer will be satisfied with that particular service provider, and it also generates positive post-purchase behaviour of the customer (Nguyen et al., 2023). Quality service not only increases sales but also helps to maintain good relationships with customers, which helps the service provider to retain customers (Wilistyorini & Sussanto, 2022). Sales persons' training also plays a key role in providing a quality service and customer satisfaction, trained sales persons can facilitate customers more effectively compared to untrained sales persons (Sann et al., 2024). Service quality is the major tool to generate positive word of mouth and encourages customers for repurchase intentions, hotel managers try to provide quality services to the customers to make customers

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satisfied. Hotel managers can provide quality services by providing good and hygienic food services, clean and tidy accommodation, by providing a tour guide, local transport and different sources of entertainment (Su et al., 2017).

Theoretical Framework and Hypotheses Development

Perceived Services Quality and Customer Satisfaction

Previous studies and literatures confirms that customers' satisfaction is a very significant antecedent for post-purchase behaviour intention and consistency (Ali et al., 2021). Service quality has been recognised as a significant factor in both word-of-mouth communications and customer satisfaction (Andri et al., 2022). The relationship among the perceptions of education can be summarised as follows: perceived service quality is an antecedent of customer satisfaction. Service quality has a positive influence on consumer satisfaction (Uzir et al., 2021). Previous study on customer fulfilment has also created the connection between satisfaction and service quality (Fabian et al., 2024). Many studies have investigated how perceptions of customer service quality stimulate the level of satisfaction (Perdomo et al., 2024). Service quality has a big part in business marketing, it not only plays a significant role in customer satisfaction but is also deliberated as a way to place a product in a dynamic atmosphere and is worth-driven for customers. In the hospitality context, the service quality has a direct relation with customers, which is why satisfied customers repeat their purchases in hotels (Paulose & Shakeel, 2022).

H₁: Perceived service quality has a positive impact on customer' satisfaction.

Perceived Service Quality and Repurchase Intention

Perceived service quality is characterised as the impression of potential customers about the level of quality that a product or service would offer (Bakir et al., 2024). Salem & Kiss (2022) conclude that there is a direct and significant connection between the service qualities, customer satisfaction and repurchase intentions. Customers represented an effective image for creating competitive advantages for the hotel industry (Şişman & Demirci, 2025). Teo et al. (2025) found a positive relationship between service qualities and repeat purchase intentions and also readiness to recommend. In the Indian hoteling sectors, the service quality dimensions have a positive impact and a positive relationship on consumers' loyalty and satisfaction (Kumar et al., 2025). Previous studies have investigated that service quality goes to boost the consumer's fulfilment and customer's loyalty (Izogo & Ogba, 2015). Nasir et al. (2021) argued that service quality proportions (reliability, tangible, assurance and responsiveness) and consumer repurchase intentions have a significant and positive relationship with each other. Good services qualities have a substantial influence on customer satisfaction. Ali et al. (2021) conclude that the concept of consumers' revisit intentions by examining the sequence of procedures in retention from consumer satisfaction and the perspectives of consumer services. The finding shows that the advanced level of service quality impacts the advanced level of consumer retention (Abdullah et al., 2023). Bujisic et al. (2014) indicate that good service quality generates a quality and satisfying consumption experience for the customers, which leads towards repurchase intentions.

H₂: There is a positive relationship between perceived service quality and re-purchase intentions.

Perceived Service Quality and Word of Mouth

Customers always communicate with positive word of mouth when they have an optimistic perception of the service's esteem. Companies can gain profit, decrease their advertising and acquisition costs by using positive word of mouth (Tessema et al., 2024). The researched significance of word of mouth (WOM) for the hospitality context has been very much recognised (Ali, 2022). Word of mouth has been proposed to directly affect the customer to increase revisit intention. It is identified that when consumers are satisfied with the services of their service experience, they would deliver and recommend to their friends and family members to visit the same hotels again (Gontur et al., 2022). The perceived service quality has a direct effect on behavioural intention, such as positive word of mouth (Gabbianelli & Pencarelli, 2023). Previous studies explained that word-of-mouth is the primary cause of information in the decision of customer repurchase intention. Words of mouth can be negative and positive. If consumers refer to other persons about the products or services, it is called positive word of mouth; if consumers complain to further

persons about products or services, it is called bad word of mouth (Marcos & Coelho 2021). Rimba et al. (2022) expressed that optimistic word of mouth from a well-pleased customer can be the cause of repurchasing a product or service.

H₃: Perceived service quality has a positive impact on word of mouth.

Customer Satisfaction and Repurchase Intention

Attitude and satisfaction are the foremost antecedents of consumer loyalty and repurchase intention (Nguyen et al., 2023). Customer satisfaction plays a very important role in the marketing context; if the customer is satisfied with the service, it leads him towards repurchase in the future if the same service is needed again (Tufahati et al., 2021). Miao et al. (2022) explained that satisfactions have a positive, meaningful, important and direct effect on revisit objectives. Hui et al. (2025) investigate that there is always a positive relationship between customer satisfaction and repurchase intention in the product and service context and customer satisfaction is also linked with post-purchase behaviour of the customer (Komara & Fathurahman, 2024). The service providers are always focusing on increasing the quality of services to satisfy their customers, as a satisfied consumer goes towards loyalty (Lukman et al., 2024).

H₄: There is a positive relationship between customer satisfaction and re-purchase intention.

Customer Satisfaction and Word of Mouth

Words of mouth impact the assumptions of customers; customers mostly deliver word of mouth, which he has expectations of the services (Dangaiso et al., 2024). Words of mouth and repurchase intention can be shown as a dimension of consumer loyalty (Sikombe, 2025). Kazungu & Kubenea (2023) presented that a satisfaction platform is the subsequent of the distinction between expected performance and actual performance. When the real levels of product or service are healthier than anticipated, then satisfaction will be encouraging. Nasir et al. (2021) expressed that hotel industries can calculate customer satisfaction by using guest remark cards. These cards are commonly used in welcome, accommodations and open areas in the hotels for gathering customer comments. Some hotels give the customer a questionnaire to give their comments in optimistic words of mouth or bad word of mouth and give them incentives for completing the questionnaires. Through this method of getting the information from customers and removing their areas of lacking service, it shows the accurate picture of expectations of consumer fulfilment that are above or below (Karim & Rabiul, 2024). The hotel managers are always trying their best to increase the service area to fulfil their consumers because greater customer satisfaction will lead to customer loyalty and become the source of word of mouth (Marcos & Coelho 2021).

H₅: Customer satisfaction has a positive impact on word of mouth.

Mediation Role of Customer Satisfaction between the Relationship of Perceived Service Quality and Repurchase Intention

Fared et al. (2021) expressed that the key problem for hotel managers is to fascinate and retain customers. Customers' emotions and revisit intention are playing the role of mediators of consumer satisfaction (Soeharso, 2024). Satisfaction plays the role of a mediating variable between service quality and repurchase intention (Mittal & Kaur, Mittal, 2024). In the Indian hoteling sectors, the service quality and customer satisfaction suggest consumer loyalty (Iffan et al., 2024). In this way, Customer fulfilment and satisfaction play the role of a mediating variable between service quality and consumer loyalty. Balakrishnan & Christopher (2010) investigate that service quality has been observed as an antecedent of customer fulfilment, which becomes the result of customer repurchase intention. Adi et al. (2010) exposed that consumer satisfaction has a powerful mediating effect between service quality and consumer retention.

H₆: Customer satisfaction mediates the relationship between perceived service quality and repurchase intention.

Mediation Role of Customer Satisfaction between the Relationship of Perceived Service Quality and Word of Mouth

Customer satisfaction plays a significant role in the relationship between service quality and word of mouth. If a customer is satisfied with a particular service, it will work as a referral program for the service



provider because the customer generates positive word of mouth to other people (Sugesti, 2025). Service quality is the key ingredient for customer satisfaction. If the service quality is good, then the customer will be satisfied, and when the customer is satisfied, he communicates the image of that particular service provider in a positive way to others as well (Rasheed & Rashid, 2024). Khoo (2022) concludes that if the quality of service is up to the mark, this will make customer experience satisfied and when the customer is satisfied, he will become a loyal customer of that particular service provider, and this loyalty pushes him to generate positive word of mouth in front of others.

H₇: Customer satisfaction mediates the relationship between perceived service quality and word of mouth.

Figure 1

Conceptual Model



Research Methodology

The research scrutinises the customer's perceived service quality regarding the output of repurchase intentions and word-of-mouth. The population for this research consisted of customers of hotels in Pakistan. All customers who visited the hotels were the population of this study. The investigation is taking place in well-known 3-star, 4-star and 5-star hotels in Pakistan. The respondents are selected from the different multinational companies' employees, businessmen, guests and customers of the hotels. The number of customers who visited these hotels was counted by carrying out an interview with the representative of these hotels. The data was gathered from the hotels, like Pearl Continental Islamabad hotel, Marriott hotel Islamabad, Pearl Continental Bhurban, Serena Faisalabad, Hotel One Lahore, Pearl Continental Lahore, Pine Park hotel Naran, Green Valley hotel Rawalakot and Avari hotel Karachi. The sample size was 204. The research instrument has been implemented from prior studies. Primary data was collected through the self-administered questionnaire from the consumers of hotels in Pakistan. The convenience sampling technique was used in this study. For analysing data, SPSS 21 was used. Perceived service quality was measured by 29 items derived by Parasuraman et al. (1988). Customer satisfaction was measured by three items derived by Maxham & Netemeyer (2002). Re-purchase intention was measured by three items derived by Arnold & Reynolds (2003). Word of mouth was measured by four items derived by Carroll & Ahuvia (2006). A Likert scale was used to analyse the respondents' level of agreement or disagreement with the subjective statement.

Results

SPSS software was used for checking the reliability. Table 1 shows the results of the reliability analysis. The Cronbach's alpha of perceived service quality is 0.817, customer satisfaction is 0.732, repurchase intention is 0.714 and word of mouth is 0.770.

Table 1

Reliability Statistics

Variables	Items	Cronbach's Alpha
Perceived service quality	29	0.817
Customers satisfaction	3	0.732
Repurchases intention	3	0.714
Word of mouth	4	0.770

Correlation

Table 2 shows the results of the correlation analysis. Results show that in the relationship of perceived service quality and customer satisfaction, $r = .312^{**}$ and $p = .000$, which suggests that there is a significant

and positive relationship between perceived service quality and customer satisfaction (H_1 accepted). In the relationship of perceived service quality and repurchase intention, $r = .307^{**}$ and $p = .000$, which suggests that there is a significant and positive relationship between perceived service quality and repurchase intention (H_2 accepted). In the relationship of perceived service quality and word of mouth, $r = .473^{**}$ and $p = .000$, which suggests that there is a significant and positive relationship between perceived service quality and word of mouth (H_3 accepted). In the relationship of Customer satisfaction and repurchase intentions, $r = .244^{**}$ and $p = .000$, which suggests that there is a significant and positive relationship between Customer satisfaction and repurchase intentions (H_4 accepted). In the relationship of Customer satisfaction and word of mouth, $r = .252^{**}$ and $p = .000$, which suggests that there is a significant and positive relationship between Customer satisfaction and word of mouth (H_5 accepted).

Table 2

Pearson Correlation analysis

	PSQ	RPI	WOM	CS
PSQ	1			
RPI	.307 ^{**}	1		
WOM	.473 ^{**}	.413 ^{**}	1	
CS	.312 ^{**}	.244 ^{**}	.252 ^{**}	1

Regression Analysis

Table 3 shows the results of simple linear regression. Result shows that $R^2 = .097$ and $P = .000$ in the relationship of perceived service quality and customer satisfaction, which suggests a 9.7% change in customer satisfaction occurs because of perceived service quality, and the P value is also significant, which suggests that this result is statistically significant. Result shows that $R^2 = .094$ and $P = .000$ in the relationship of perceived service quality and repurchase intention, which suggests a 9.4% change in repurchase intention occurs because of perceived service quality, and the P value is also significant, which suggests that this result is statistically significant. Result shows that $R^2 = .224$ and $P = .000$ in the relationship of perceived service quality and word of mouth, which suggests a 22.4% change in word of mouth occurs because of perceived service quality, and the P value is also significant, which suggests that this result is statistically significant. Result shows that $R^2 = .059$ and $P = .000$ in the relationship of customer satisfaction and repurchase intention, which suggests a 5.9% change in repurchase intention occurs because of customer satisfaction, and the P value is also significant, which suggests that this result is statistically significant. Result shows that $R^2 = .063$ and $P = .000$ in the relationship of customer satisfaction and word of mouth, which suggests a 6.3% change in word of mouth occurs because of customer satisfaction, and the P value is also significant, which suggests that this result is statistically significant.

Table 3

Simple Linear Regression

	CS		RPI		WOM	
	R ²	B	R ²	B	R ²	B
Predictors						
Main Effects						
PSQ	.097***	.312***	.094***	0.307***	.224***	.473***
CS			.059***	0.244***	.063***	.252***

Mediation 1

Table 4 shows the result of the mediation analysis. Result shows that $R^2 = .111$ in the direct relationship of perceived service quality and repurchase intention and $R^2 = .148$ when customer satisfaction runs as a mediator, which suggests that customer satisfaction plays a significant mediating role. R-squared change value is .037, which approaches zero, and P value is .004, which is significant. Results suggest that one condition of Baron & Kenny (1986) mediation is fulfilled, and the second is not, which shows that there is partial mediation (H_6 partially accepted).

**Table 4***Mediation-1*

	B	R ²	RPI	P
			ΔR^2	
Step-1				
Demographics		.061	.061	.073
Step-2				
CS	.166	.111	.050	.001
Step-2				
PSQ	.241	.148	.037	.004

Mediation 2

Table 5 shows the result of the mediation analysis. Result shows that $R^2 = .274$ in the direct relationship of perceived service quality and word of mouth, and $R^2 = .344$ when customer satisfaction runs as a mediator, which suggests that customer satisfaction plays a significant mediating role. R-squared change value is .070, which approaches zero, and P value is .000, which is significant. Results suggest that one condition of Baron & Kenny (1986) mediation is fulfilled, and the second one is not, which shows that there is partial mediation (H_7 partially accepted).

Table 5*Mediation-2*

	B	R ²	WOM	P
			ΔR^2	
Step-1				
Demographics		.213	.213	.000
Step-2				
CS	.163	.274	.061	.000
Step-2				
PSQ	.332	.344	.070	.000

Practical Implications

Perceived service quality helps to promote the relationship with consumers and the service provider, by encouraging the consumers' repurchase intentions and increasing the word of mouth. Particularly, the hotel managers should work more to develop their business by using the techniques of providing good service quality to their customers. In this way, their business becomes more developed. Hotel managers should use the different kinds of techniques to improve their service quality dimensions. Both perceived performance and overall service quality dimensions can become the cause of growth for the business. Hotel managers should adopt the different positive consequences of consumers' company identification techniques to reduce their acquisition cost and advertising cost. Service organisations are utilising the advantages of the identification with their loyal customer, which becomes the source of reputation and also becomes a positive output, like repurchasing intention and positive word of mouth. When the relationship became strong with the service provider, then the customer became loyal, and loyal customers become the key source of positive word of mouth and repurchase intention. Customers show their attachment as loyal customers with the organisation by using the quality of the service. When consumers got quality services from the hotel, the outcome was customer satisfaction, which enhances repurchase behaviours, generates positive word-of-mouth and reduces the possibility of switching to competitors.

Limitations and Directions for Future Research

This study has some limitations, which are reflected as restrictions in the generalizability. Less financial Support is also known as a limitation of this study. Since this study was conducted only in Pakistan, it is also a major limitation of this study. In this research majority of the respondents were male and female are less as combine with them. Mostly, females were hesitating and not ready to give the information or response. The current research used the hypotheses with Pakistani hotels and used convenience sampling, which can question the generalizability of the data. So, other sampling techniques can be used for future research for more geographically and ethnically diverse populations. There are a limited number of

constructs in the model, and further antecedents are "service fairness, corporate reputation and price sensitivity," which made the future research much comprehensive. Future researchers could use further connections quality constructs like trust, commitment and communication quality in this model.



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